

August  
**16**

**1501**

## Marble masterpiece

Italian Renaissance artist Michelangelo was asked to carve a statue from a 5.2 m (17 ft) tall block of marble in Florence, Italy. The sculpture, called *David*, took him three years to complete.



## Also on this day

**1858** The first transatlantic telegram was sent from the UK to the USA via 4,000 km (2,500 miles) of cable under the Atlantic Ocean.

**1896** Three men discovered gold in a tributary of the Klondike River in Yukon, Canada, setting off the Klondike Gold Rush.

**2007** Chinese officials reported that a couple had named their baby “@” (at), which translates as “love him” in Chinese.

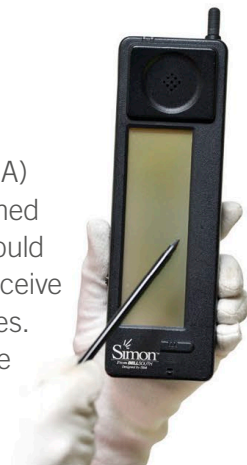
## Born this day

**1958** Madonna, US singer, songwriter, and actor. Known for frequently changing her image, the “queen of Pop” has sold more than 300 million records worldwide.

**1994**

## First smartphone

A personal digital assistant (PDA) called “IBM Simon” was launched by US tech company IBM. It could make phone calls, send and receive emails and faxes, and take notes. This PDA is now considered the world’s first smartphone.



**2018**

## Gollum fish

After severe flooding in Kerala, India, locals discovered a new species of fish that had been flushed out of its underground habitat. The Gollum snakehead was named after the underground-dwelling character from the fantasy book *The Lord of the Rings*.

